

Centre-Back Scouting Case Study

Finding a Replacement Profile for Marc Guðmundsson

Objective

This project identifies statistically similar centre-back profiles using UEFA Euro 2024 performance data.

The objective:

Identify potential replacement profiles for Marc Guðmundsson based on defensive and possession metrics.

Dataset

Competition:

UEFA Euro 2024

Data source:

StatsBomb Open Data

Sample:

- 51 matches analysed
- 108 centre-backs identified
- Minimum threshold: 270 minutes played

Methodology

Players were compared using:

Defensive metrics

- Tackles per 90
- Interceptions per 90
- Clearances per 90

Possession metrics

- Pass completion percentage
- Progressive passes per 90

A similarity model was created using normalised statistical distance.

Target Player

Marc Guðmundsson

Team:

England

Position:

Centre-back

Profile:

- Reliable defender
- Strong positioning
- Secure passer
- Comfortable progressing possession

Closest Statistical Matches

The model identified the following profiles:

1. Robin Le Normand ÖÇö Spain
2. Jan Vertonghen ÖÇö Belgium
3. Riccardo Calafiori ÖÇö Italy
4. Wout Faes ÖÇö Belgium
5. Jonathan Tah ÖÇö Germany

Player Assessment

Robin Le Normand

Strengths:

- Similar defensive output
- Strong passing reliability
- Experienced positioning

Fit:

Closest overall statistical profile.

Riccardo Calafiori

Strengths:

- Progressive passing
- Ball progression

- Tactical flexibility

Fit:

Higher-upside modern centre-back profile.

Key Findings

The analysis suggests that replacement profiles for Marc Guðhi should combine:

- Defensive consistency
- Passing security
- Progressive ability
- Tactical adaptability

Limitations

The model does not include:

- Aerial duel quality
- Defensive context
- Opposition strength
- Tracking data
- Tactical role differences

The output should support scouting decisions rather than replace expert judgement.

Conclusion

Data analysis can identify comparable player profiles and support recruitment decisions.

The strongest candidates combine defensive reliability with modern possession ability.